TO THE SKY

FREE GUIDE

Connect Claude to Google Tag Manager

The setup I use at my agency. Claude builds your tracking, tests it on your site in Chrome, and tells you what works. You decide what goes live.

Inside: what you need · 3 setup steps · the build and test workflow · prompts to copy · the mistakes I made so you don't

WHAT YOU GET

You tell Claude what to track. It does the rest.

Once the setup below is done, Claude can:

- go into your GTM container and read every tag, trigger and variable
- create conversion tags and triggers in a draft workspace
- check that the setup is correct
- open your site in Chrome, read the console and test that each event fires
- tell you what works and what doesn't

You review and you press publish.

Two connectors make this work

GTM connector (MCP)	Lets Claude read and edit your container: tags, triggers, variables, versions.
Chrome DevTools MCP	Free, from the Google Chrome team. Lets Claude open your site, see the network requests, the dataLayer and the console errors.

The GTM connector builds the tag. Chrome DevTools proves it fires. Together, nothing is guessed.

What you need

- Claude Code (in the terminal, or the Code tab of the Claude desktop app)
- A Google account with access to your GTM container
- Node.js installed (for Chrome DevTools MCP)
- About 30 minutes, once

STEP 1 · GOOGLE CLOUD

Give Claude permission to use the Tag Manager API

This is the only part with Google settings. You do it once.

1. Go to **console.cloud.google.com** and create a project (any name).
2. In **APIs & Services → Library**, search **Tag Manager API** and click **Enable**.
3. In **OAuth consent screen**, set it up for your own account (type External is fine).
4. In **Credentials → Create credentials → OAuth client ID**, choose **Desktop app**. Download the JSON file.
5. When the connector asks for access, approve these scopes: edit containers, edit container versions, publish.

> **Publish the consent screen to Production.** In Testing mode Google expires your access after 7 days and the connector stops working. I learned this the hard way.

> When you sign in, Google may say the app isn't verified. It's your own app. Click **Advanced → Go to [your project]** and continue.

> Leave out the "delete containers" scope. Claude doesn't need it, and it's safer without it.

STEP 2 · GTM CONNECTOR

Install the GTM connector

I use an open-source GTM MCP server. Two good options:

VasthavM/google-tag-manager-mcp	What I run. About 50 tools, full read and write, including publish. Works with your personal Google sign-in.
stape-io/google-tag-manager-mcp-server	More mature, installs from npm, also supports a service account. A good choice if you're starting fresh.

Follow the README of the one you pick, point it to the JSON file from Step 1, sign in once with Google, then add it to Claude:

```
claude mcp add gtm --scope user -- [path to the connector]
```

Restart Claude and test it:

TEST

List my GTM accounts and containers.

STEP 3 · CHROME DEVTOOLS

Add Chrome DevTools MCP

One command. It works in every project.

```
claude mcp add chrome-devtools -s user -- npx -y chrome-devtools-mcp@latest
```

Restart Claude. The first run opens its own Chrome window.

TEST

Open my site and show me any console errors.

THE WORKFLOW

Build, test, then you publish

This is how I set up a conversion now.

1	2	3	4	5
Claude creates the tag and trigger in a draft workspace	Claude opens the site in Chrome and does the action	Claude checks the request, the dataLayer and the console	Claude reports what fired and what didn't	You review and publish

What Claude checks in step 3

- **Network:** the conversion request leaves the page (Google Ads, GA4, Meta)
- **dataLayer:** the event is there, with the right value and currency
- **Console:** zero errors from your tags

> **Keep the last click for yourself.** Claude can publish, but I don't let it. It drafts and tests, I look at the result, I publish.

Ask Claude to name the workspace after the change (for example "purchase-tag-fix"), so you can see exactly what it touched.

PROMPTS TO COPY

Start with an audit, then build

Audit your container

DUPLICATES

Go through my GTM container and list every tag that can fire twice on the same page. Tell me why.

DEAD TAGS

Which tags have no trigger, or a trigger that can never fire?

OLD PIXELS

List all third-party pixels in the container and when each was last changed. Flag the ones that look forgotten.

PURCHASE VALUE

Check my purchase tags. Do they send the order value and currency from the dataLayer, or a fixed number?

CHANGES

Compare the live version with the previous one. What changed?

Build and test

BUILD

In a new draft workspace, create a [Google Ads / GA4 / Meta] conversion tag for [form submit / purchase] and the trigger for it. Don't publish.

TEST

Open [URL] in Chrome, do the [form submit / purchase] step, and confirm the conversion request is sent, the dataLayer event is correct and there are no console errors.

REPORT

Give me a short list: what works, what doesn't, and what you'd change before I publish.

BEFORE YOU START

Mistakes I made, so you don't

- **Consent screen left in Testing.** Access expired after 7 days. Publish it to Production.
- **New connector not showing up.** Claude only loads new connectors after a restart.
- **Working in the default workspace.** Use a new draft workspace for every change, so you can throw it away.
- **Trusting "the tag is set up".** Always run the Chrome test. A tag that exists isn't a tag that fires.
- **Letting it decide what to track.** Claude knows GTM. It doesn't know which action is worth money in your business. You tell it.

Want me to check your tracking?

I run this audit for agencies and businesses that spend on Meta and Google Ads. Send me a message on LinkedIn with "GTM audit" and your site, and I'll tell you the first three things I'd fix.

Message me on LinkedIn

This is post 1 of 7 in my series on connecting Claude to the tools I use to run ads. Next: Google Analytics 4, and how I check if the numbers in it are real.